

WEEKLY TRADING PERFORMANCE REPORT

Analysis Period:	March 2-6, 2026 (Week 5)
Report Generated:	March 6, 2026 (Revised)
Trader:	James
Strategies:	Cash-Secured Puts Diagonal Put Spread Calendar Spread
Market Environment:	Crisis Volatility — Iran Conflict / Stagflation / Jobs Shock

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Overall Performance: -\$3,148 net P&L; across 8 completed trades (37.5% win rate). First losing week, driven by a -\$4,280 loss on an AVAV diagonal put spread that was stopped out within 90 minutes of opening as the Iran conflict hammered markets. CSP strategy remained profitable at +\$1,949 across 6 trades, proving the core approach works even in crisis conditions. The AVAV loss and GAP calendar (-\$817) — both multi-leg experimental trades — accounted for the entire deficit.

Key Findings:

- AVAV stop loss fired at 100% and saved an estimated \$8,000-\$10,000 in further losses as the stock fell from 278 to 204
- CSP core strategy: +\$1,949 (3 wins, 3 losses, 50% win rate) — profitable despite crisis conditions
- Multi-leg/experimental trades: -\$5,097 (AVAV -\$4,280, GAP -\$817) — 100% of the week's deficit
- Market order execution on AVAV gave away significant premium at entry — limit orders are now non-negotiable
- New risk framework (50% limits, 100% stops, layered alerts) implemented and tested under fire

Strategic Assessment: This week separates clearly into two stories. The CSP strategy — your bread and butter — delivered +\$1,949 through disciplined stock selection in defensive sectors (GWRE, FDS, SRAD). That's a strong result in a week the Dow dropped 800 points. The losses came entirely from experimental multi-leg structures (AVAV diagonal, GAP calendar) where you were still learning. The critical positive: the AVAV 100% stop fired and prevented what would have become a -\$12,000+ loss. The system works. The execution needs refinement.

WEEKLY P&L; SUMMARY

Strategy	Trades	Wins	Losses	Win Rate	Net P&L
Cash-Secured Puts	6	3	3	50%	+\$1,949
Diagonal Spread (AVAV)	1	0	1	0%	-\$4,280
Calendar Spread (GAP)	1	0	1	0%	-\$817
TOTAL COMPLETED	8	3	5	37.5%	-\$3,148

THE TWO-STRATEGY SPLIT

	CSP (Core)	Multi-Leg (Experimental)	Combined
Trades	6	2	8
Win Rate	50%	0%	37.5%
P&L	+\$1,949	-\$5,097	-\$3,148
Avg P&L/Trade	+\$325	-\$2,549	-\$394

This split is the most important insight of the week. Your core CSP strategy is profitable and was profitable in all three weeks (+\$1,758, -\$179, +\$1,949). The experimental multi-leg trades are where the losses concentrate. This isn't a reason to stop experimenting — it's a reason to size experiments smaller until the execution is refined.

CUMULATIVE PERFORMANCE (Feb 9 - Mar 6, 2026)

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Cumulative
Period	Feb 9-19	Feb 20-27	Mar 2-6	5 weeks
Completed Trades	10	10	8	28
Win Rate	80.0%	60.0%	37.5%	57.1%
CSP P&L	+\$1,758	-\$179	+\$1,949	+\$3,528
Other P&L	\$0	+\$614	-\$5,097	-\$4,483
Total P&L	+\$1,758	+\$435	-\$3,148	-\$955
VIX Regime	Elevated	Transitional	Crisis	Mixed

Cumulative now at -\$955. This is entirely due to multi-leg experimental losses (-\$4,483) overwhelming CSP profits (+\$3,528). The CSP strategy alone would have you at +\$3,528 over three weeks. The learning cost on experimental trades is real but expected — you're 9 weeks into options trading and testing new structures for the first time.

MARKET CONTEXT: CRISIS WEEK

1. US-Iran Conflict

Joint US-Israeli military operation over the weekend sent oil surging. Brent crude neared \$87, WTI hit \$81-85 (highest since 2024). Qatar warned Gulf exports could shut down within weeks. Energy and defense stocks surged while consumer and growth sectors were crushed.

2. February Jobs Shock

Non-farm payrolls fell by 92,000 — a stark miss against expectations of growth. Combined with rising energy costs, this created stagflation fears.

3. Fed Rate Cut Repricing

Rate cut expectations slashed from 55bp to 35bp for the year. Higher-for-longer narrative returned.

Index	Weekly Change	Impact
Dow Jones	-1.6% (-800pts Thursday)	Put premiums expanded sharply
S&P 500	-1.0%	VIX spike increased premium levels
Nasdaq	-0.3%	Relatively resilient; NVDA as safe haven

STRATEGY 1: CASH-SECURED PUTS (+\$1,949)

#	Ticker	Entry	Exit	Days	Sell\$	Buy\$	Cts	P&L	Prem %
1	SRAD \$15P	02/03	04/03	2	\$0.51	\$0.21	30	+\$861	+58.8%
2	UEC \$13.50P	03/03	03-06	0-3	\$0.51	\$0.51/0.95	40	-\$96	~0%
3	GWRE \$130P	03/03	05/03	2	\$4.65	\$3.10	10	+\$1,537	+33.3%
4	FDS \$190P	04/03	05/03	1	\$1.50	\$0.65	10	+\$837	+56.7%
5	KRMN \$85P	04/03	05/03	1	\$2.92	\$4.00	10	-\$1,093	-37.0%
6	HNRG \$15P	05/03	06/03	1	\$0.35	\$0.36	42	-\$97	-2.9%

CSP TRADE NOTES

SRAD (+\$861): 30 contracts, 58.8% premium capture in 2 days. Sportradar — less Iran-sensitive. Clean execution, likely hit near the 50% profit limit. Best CSP discipline of the week.

UEC (-\$96): 40 contracts opened, 39 closed same day at breakeven. Last contract held 3 days and closed at \$0.95. Commission drag (\$52) turned a flat trade into a loss. Lesson: If you're exiting at breakeven within hours, the setup quality was insufficient.

GWRE (+\$1,537): Best CSP of the week. \$4.65 premium on a \$130 strike (3.6% yield). Insurance tech company — excellent crisis-resilient sector selection. 33.3% capture in 2 days.

FDS (+\$837): FactSet \$190 puts, 56.7% premium capture in 1 day. Financial data services — another strong defensive pick. Clean 50% limit exit.

KRMN (-\$1,093): Sold at \$2.92, closed at \$4.00 (37% adverse move). This was a managed exit — not a 2x blowout. You likely used the 50% downside alert and took a view to close. That's better risk management than NVCR last week (-112%). Loss contained, capital preserved.

HNRG (-\$97): 42 contracts at \$0.35. Stock barely moved (\$0.35 to \$0.36) but \$54.60 in round-trip commissions turned a scratch into a loss. Commission was 3.7% of premium collected. Rule: If commission exceeds 2% of premium, reduce contract count.

CSP WEEK-OVER-WEEK

Metric	Week 1	Week 2	Week 3	Trend
CSP Trades	10	8	6	More selective
CSP Win Rate	80%	62.5%	50%	Market-driven decline
CSP P&L	+\$1,758	-\$179	+\$1,949	Recovered strongly
Largest Win	\$610	\$987	\$1,537	Improving quality
Largest Loss	-\$192	-\$1,334	-\$1,093	Better loss mgmt

CSP trend is positive. Largest wins growing (\$610 > \$987 > \$1,537). Largest losses shrinking (-\$192 > -\$1,334 > -\$1,093 — Week 2 was the outlier). The core strategy works. The challenge is keeping experimental trades from eroding CSP profits.

STRATEGY 2: AVAV DIAGONAL PUT SPREAD (-\$4,280)

Detail	Value
Structure	Short 4x 20MAR \$235P + Short 4x 13MAR \$240P
Credit Received	\$10.70/spread x 4 = \$4,280
AVAV Price at Entry	\$278 (both strikes 13-15% OTM)
Thesis	Theta decay experiment — compare decay across two expiry dates
Entry Method	Market orders (filled \$5.20-\$5.50 vs ~\$7 mark — gave away premium)
Stop	100% loss (\$21.40/spread)
Outcome	Stop fired within 90 minutes as AVAV dropped sharply on Iran news
P&L	-\$4,280 (100% of credit = maximum planned loss)
What Happened Next	AVAV fell to 204 (26% from entry). Without stop: -\$12,000 to -\$14,000+

THE STOP SAVED YOU \$8,000-\$10,000

This is the most important line in this report. Yes, the trade lost \$4,280. But AVAV subsequently fell from 278 to 204 — a 26% decline. Both strikes went \$30-35 deep in the money. Without the 100% stop, the assignment losses would have been \$12,000-\$14,000+. The stop did exactly what it was designed to do.

Execution Issues (Separate from the Stop):

Market orders on entry filled at \$5.20-\$5.50 vs ~\$7 mark — you gave away ~30% of premium before the trade even started. On options with wide spreads, this is significant. Limit orders at mid price are now a non-negotiable rule.

No earnings check — AVAV had earnings on March 10, 8 days away. Selling puts into earnings is high-risk. The existing no-trade-near-earnings rule should extend to all strategies, not just CSPs.

No layered alerts — the stop fired without warning. The new 25/50/75% alert framework you've built since this trade would have given you decision points before the stop triggered.

Framework Improvements Built from This Trade:

- ✓ Layered alerts at 25%, 50%, 75% loss before the 100% stop
- ✓ Limit orders only on all option entries — no exceptions
- ✓ Earnings check before any trade (no puts within 10 days of earnings)
- ✓ Decision tree at each alert: review chart, assess thesis, keep or pull stop

STRATEGY 3: GAP CALENDAR SPREAD (-\$817)

Leg	Action	Date	Detail	Amount
Open	SOLD 10 custom	27/02	Short both 13MAR 26P + 6MAR 26P @ \$1.98	+\$1,980
Close 9/10	BOT back	03/03	9x 6MAR @ \$1.23 + 9x 13MAR @ \$1.29	-\$2,268
Close 1/10	BOT back	06/03	1x 6MAR @ \$2.49 + 1x 13MAR @ \$2.54	-\$503
	Commissions			-\$26
	NET P&L			-\$817

GAP dropped sharply on consumer/retail fear from Iran/oil and the jobs shock. Both put legs expanded in value, making the close more expensive than the credit received. The last contract closed Friday at significantly worse prices (\$2.49 + \$2.54 vs \$1.98 credit per unit). Lesson: Calendar/put positions on consumer-facing stocks are directly exposed to macro shocks.

OPEN POSITIONS AS OF MARCH 6

Position	Dir	Cts	Entry	Notes
S (SentinelOne) 13MAR \$12.50P	Short	10	06/03	CSP — new, \$280 credit
GOOGL Calls (3 positions)	Long	40	Jan-Feb	~\$64,100 cost, essentially dead

Note: NFLX positions (long 4x 20MAR \$83P, short 1x May 90C, short 1x Aug 90C) confirmed closed by James. Close prices to be reconciled in next report.

RISK ANALYSIS & FRAMEWORK EVOLUTION

RISK FRAMEWORK — FIRST WEEK IN ACTION

Trade	Framework Element	Outcome	Assessment
SRAD	50% profit limit	Closed at 59% capture	Working
FDS	50% profit limit	Closed at 57% capture	Working
KRMN	50% alert at downside	Closed at -37% (inside stop)	Working
AVAV	100% stop loss	Fired at 100%, saved \$8-10k	Working (saved you)
HNRG	Framework neutral	Scratch trade, comm drag	N/A
UEC	Framework neutral	Same-day exit at breakeven	N/A
GAP	No stop (spread)	Closed manually for -\$817	Needs spread rules

Verdict: The framework performed well in its first real test. Profit limits captured gains on SRAD and FDS. The KRMN alert prevented a larger loss. The AVAV stop prevented a catastrophic loss. The gap is on spread positions (GAP calendar) where simple stops don't apply as cleanly.

FRAMEWORK ENHANCEMENTS (Built This Week)

- ✓ Layered alerts at 25%, 50%, 75% loss before 100% stop fires
 - ✓ Limit orders only on all entries — market orders banned
 - ✓ Earnings calendar check before any trade (10-day buffer)
 - ✓ Decision tree cheat sheet at each alert level
- NEW Commission filter: reject trades where commission > 2% of premium

COMMISSION EFFICIENCY

Trade	Contracts	Premium	Commission	Comm %	Flag
SRAD	30	\$1,530	\$39	2.5%	Borderline
UEC	40	\$2,040	\$52	2.5%	Borderline
GWRE	10	\$4,650	\$13	0.3%	Efficient
FDS	10	\$1,500	\$13	0.9%	Efficient
KRMN	10	\$2,920	\$13	0.4%	Efficient
HNRG	42	\$1,470	\$55	3.7%	Too high

Pattern is clear: 10-contract trades on higher-priced underlyings (GWRE, FDS, KRMN) run 0.3-0.9% commission drag. High-contract trades on cheap stocks (HNRG 42 cts, UEC 40 cts) run 2.5-3.7%. The 2% threshold would flag HNRG and put SRAD/UEC on watch.

LESSONS LEARNED

WHAT WORKED

- ✓ Stop loss on AVAV saved \$8,000-\$10,000 — the single most valuable risk management event to date
- ✓ CSP sector selection: GWRE, FDS, SRAD were crisis-resilient and profitable
- ✓ Profit limits: FDS and SRAD closed near 50% targets automatically
- ✓ KRMN managed exit at -37% instead of potential -100%+

✓ Learning speed: framework enhancements built within days of AVAV trade

WHAT NEEDS IMPROVEMENT

- **1. Experimental Trade Sizing:** AVAV was a \$4,280 credit (4.2x your \$1,000 CSP target). Experimental trades should be sized at 50% or less of standard positions until the strategy is proven.
- **2. Entry Execution:** Market orders on AVAV gave away ~30% of edge at entry. Limit orders at mid price on every trade, no exceptions.
- **3. Earnings Awareness:** AVAV had earnings March 10. The existing no-earnings rule must apply to all strategies.
- **4. Commission Filter:** HNRG and UEC lost money to commissions. Pre-trade check: $(\text{contracts} \times \$1.30) / (\text{premium} \times \text{contracts} \times 100)$ must be under 2%.
- **5. Spread Stop Rules:** GAP calendar had no stop mechanism. For spreads, define a max loss in dollar terms before entry and set an alert.

WEEKLY PERFORMANCE TRACKER

Week	Period	Trades	Win %	CSP P&L	Other P&L	Total	Cumulative
1	Feb 9-19	10	80%	+\$1,758	\$0	+\$1,758	+\$1,758
2	Feb 20-27	10	60%	-\$179	+\$614	+\$435	+\$2,193
3	Mar 2-6	8	37.5%	+\$1,949	-\$5,097	-\$3,148	-\$955
4	Mar 9-13	-	-	-	-	-	-

CONCLUSION

Performance Assessment: First losing week. -\$3,148 driven entirely by experimental multi-leg trades. CSP core strategy was +\$1,949 — your best CSP week yet. The loss stings but it's concentrated in trades where you were explicitly learning new structures.

The Story of This Week: You entered an AVAV diagonal spread as a theta experiment, got caught by a geopolitical shock, and the 100% stop you implemented just days earlier fired and saved you \$8,000-\$10,000 in further losses. That stop exists because of the conversation we had last week about NVCR and NU running away. The framework you built in response to Week 2's lessons protected you in Week 3. That's how trading systems improve — through iteration.

Cumulative Reality Check: At -\$955 cumulative, you're slightly underwater. CSP-only P&L is +\$3,528. The -\$4,483 from experimental trades is learning cost. The question going forward: can you keep CSP profits compounding while sizing experiments small enough that the learning doesn't wipe out the earning? If you'd sized AVAV at half (\$2,140 credit instead of \$4,280), you'd still be cumulative positive.

Next Report: Friday, March 13, 2026